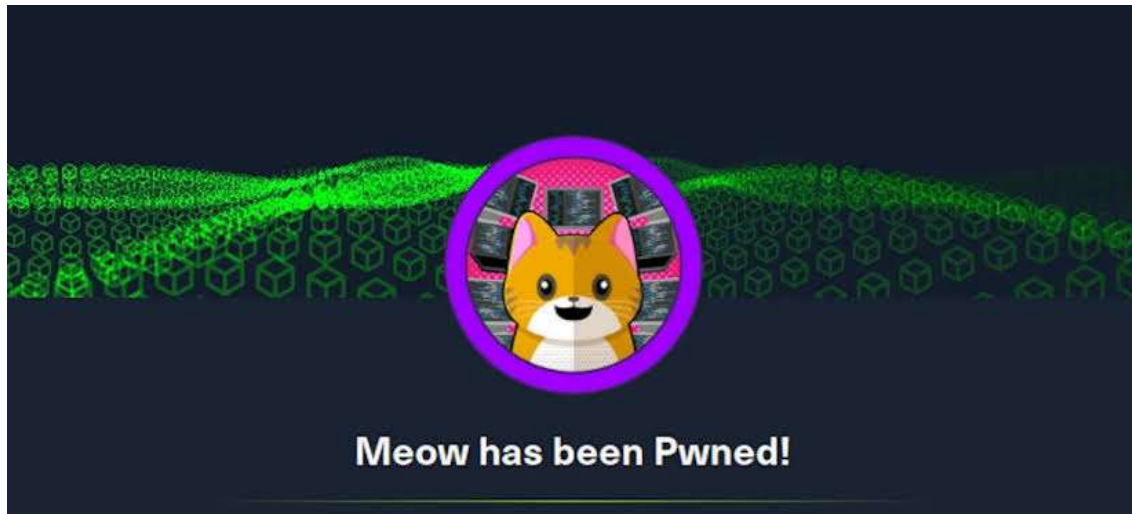


Hello everyone!

In this walkthrough, we'll solve the Meow CTF room on HackTheBox by performing enumeration and exploitation.



Tools

1. Nmap

Description

Enumeration is a crucial initial step in penetration testing, where information about a target system is gathered. It involves identifying open ports, services, and potential vulnerabilities to understand the system's network role. Tools like Nmap are commonly used to scan for these details. The process requires thoroughness, as missing key details can lead to overlooked attack vectors. Successful enumeration provides a solid foundation for further testing and exploitation.

Enumeration

Enumeration After our VPN connection is successfully established, we can ping the target's IP address to see if our packets reach their destination. You can take the IP address of your current target from the Starting Point lab's page and paste it into your terminal after typing in the ping command as illustrated below.

Ananalysis

Step:-1 This nmap command is to run a scan on the 10.129.54.34 IP address and includes the following options:

-Pn: Bypass the ping scan and do port scanning directly, assuming all hosts are live.

-sV: Do service version scanning, which will reveal which services and their versions are running on which ports.

```
sudo nmap -sV 10.129.54.34
```

```
hacker@kali: ~/Downloads x root@Meow: ~ x
(hacker@kali)-[~]
$ sudo nmap -sV 10.129.54.34
Starting Nmap 7.94SVN ( https://nmap.org ) at 2024-10-09 18:47 IST
Nmap scan report for 10.129.54.34
Host is up (0.52s latency).
Not shown: 999 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE VERSION
23/tcp    open  telnet  Linux telnetd
Service Info: OS: Linux; CPE: cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel

Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 16.86 seconds
```

Step:-2 After completing the scan, we discovered that port 23/tcp is open and running the Telnet service, an outdated protocol used for remote network management. A quick search reveals that Telnet typically requires a username and password for security. In this case, when connecting to the target, we were greeted with a Hack The Box banner and prompted to authenticate before proceeding with remote management of the host.

The command telnet 10.129.54.34 is used to establish a Telnet connection to the target machine at the IP address 10.129.54.34 .

```
hacker@kali: ~/Downloads x root@Meow: ~ x
(hacker@kali)-[~]
$ telnet 10.129.54.34
Trying 10.129.54.34 ...
Connected to 10.129.54.34.
Escape character is '^]'.

Hack the Box

Meow login: root
Welcome to Ubuntu 20.04.2 LTS (GNU/Linux 5.4.0-77-generic x86_64)

* Documentation:  https://help.ubuntu.com
* Management:    https://landscape.canonical.com
* Support:       https://ubuntu.com/advantage

System information as of Wed 09 Oct 2024 01:19:53 PM UTC

System load:          0.08
Usage of /:            41.7% of 7.75GB
Memory usage:         4%
Swap usage:           0%
Processes:            135
Users logged in:      0
IPv4 address for eth0: 10.129.54.34
IPv6 address for eth0: dead:beef::250:56ff:feb0:a3d7
```

Success! We have logged into the target system.

Step:-3 The ls command in Linux is used to list the contents of a directory. It's one of the most commonly used commands for navigating the file system.

The cat command in Linux is used to view, concatenate, and manipulate files.

```
* Super-optimized for small spaces - read how we shrank the memory
  footprint of MicroK8s to make it the smallest full K8s around.

  https://ubuntu.com/blog/microk8s-memory-optimisation

75 updates can be applied immediately.
31 of these updates are standard security updates.
To see these additional updates run: apt list --upgradable

The list of available updates is more than a week old.
To check for new updates run: sudo apt update

Last login: Mon Sep  6 15:15:23 UTC 2021 from 10.10.14.18 on pts/0
root@Meow:~# ls
flag.txt  snap
root@Meow:~# cat flag.txt
b40abdfе23665f766f9c61ecba8a4c19
root@Meow:~#
```

Finally flag are found

Task 1

What does the acronym VM stand for?

Virtual Machine

Task 2

What tool do we use to interact with the operating system in order to issue commands via the command line, such as the one to start our VPN connection? It's also known as a console or shell.

terminal

Task 3

What service do we use to form our VPN connection into HTB labs?

openvpn

Task 4

What tool do we use to test our connection to the target with an ICMP echo request?

ping

Task 5

What is the name of the most common tool for finding open ports on a target?

nmap

Task 6

What service do we identify on port 23/tcp during our scans?

telnet

Task 7

What username is able to log into the target over telnet with a blank password?

root

Submit Flag

Submit root flag

b40abdfc23665f766f9c61ecba8a4c19

Thanks! for Visiting